AI Prompting Frameworks for Leadership Coaches

Mastering Communication with Large Language Models for Immediate Impact and Future Relevance

Chain-of-Thought (CoT)

The Concept

Encourages the AI to "show its work" by breaking down complex reasoning into sequential steps, rather than guessing the answer immediately.

Application for Coaches

Use this for Organizational Diagnosis. When analysing a client's limiting belief system or complex 360-degree feedback, CoT forces the AI to connect the dots logically.

Prompt Example

> "I am coaching a CEO resistant to delegating. Walk me through a step-by-step analysis of why a founder might fear letting go. For each step, suggest a probing question I can ask."

Future Strategic Advantage: The AI Auditor

AI is evolving towards "System 2" thinking (deliberate reasoning). By mastering CoT, you train yourself to audit AI logic. As AI begins making autonomous business decisions, you have the insights to trace and correct its reasoning, ensuring strategic advice is sound and unbiased.

Few-Shot Prompting

The Concept

Providing specific examples ("shots") within the prompt to guide the AI's output format, style, and tone.

Application for Coaches

Essential for Content Calibration. Use this to generate emails, feedback, or session notes that match your specific "Coaching Voice"-whether Socratic, empathetic, or provocative.

Prompt Example

> "I need to write feedback. Here are three examples of how I deliver 'tough love' feedback [Insert Examples]. Based on these, draft a note for a client sessions."

Future Strategic Advantage: Digital Twin Curation

Prompting is evolving into "Curating." Mastering Few-Shot teaches you to select the right data. Soon, you won't simply type prompts; you will build fine-tuned "Digital Twins" of yourself. Your ability to curate examples will determine the quality of your digital scalability.

Role Prompting

The Concept

Assigning a specific persona to the AI to access specialised knowledge bases or simulate specific stakeholders.

Application for Coaches

High-Stakes Simulation. Turn the AI into a "Difficult Employee" or "Aggressive Board Member" to role-play scenarios before your actual coaching sessions.

Prompt Example

"Act as a sceptical CFO who believes executive coaching is a waste of budget. I will pitch the ROI of my programme to you. Critique my arguments ruthlessly."

Future Strategic Advantage: Immersive Training Design

As AI moves to VR/AR avatars, mastering Role Prompting creates the foundation for designing immersive training environments.

Zero-Shot Prompting

The Concept

Direct instructions with no examples. Best used for rapid, foundational knowledge or simple tasks.

Application for Coaches

Velocity & Knowledge Retrieval. Use this for quick definitions, generating lists of ice-breakers, or summarising management frameworks on the fly during prep time.

Prompt Example

> "Explain the 'SCARF Model' of social threats to me as if I were a newly promoted manager with no/limited psychology background."

Future Strategic Advantage: AI-OS Fluency

Future AI interaction won't be a chat; it will be integrated into your OS (like Microsoft Copilot). Mastering concise, zero-shot commands ensures you maintain high velocity when AI is an invisible layer in your workflow, rather than a separate chatbot.

The CRISPE Framework

The Concept

A heavy-duty structure for complex outputs: Context, Role, Instructions, Steps, Parameters, Examples.

Application for Coaches

Curriculum Architecture. Use this when designing long-term assets like 6-month coaching journeys, workshop agendas, or keynote speeches.

01

Context

Designing a retreat

02

Role

Expert Facilitator

03

Instructions

Outline agenda

04

Steps

Break down by hour

05

Parameters

Focus on trust

06

Examples

Use Lencioni-style activities

CRISPE Framework: Future Strategic Advantage

Low-Code Tool Building

CRISPE mimics the syntax of coding. Mastering this prepares you to build Custom Coaching Apps. As tools allow non-coders to build software via text, your ability to structure requirements via CRISPE will allow you to build proprietary software tools without developers.

> The future of coaching isn't simply about working with AI-it's about building with it.

The Elite Unified Framework: PRIME

For the Master Coach: PRIME consolidates all frameworks into a repeatable workflow for high-level strategy.

Persona

Assign a role (e.g., "Act as a Top Strategist")

Role & Context

Define the situation (e.g., "Client undergoing M&A")

Inputs & Examples

Supply data (e.g., "Here are the survey results")

Method

Instruct reasoning (e.g., "Think step-by-step using CoT")

Evaluate & Refine

Output, then ask the AI to critique its own work

Comparing the Frameworks

Framework	Best For	Complexity	Future Skill
Chain-of-Thought	Complex analysis	Medium	AI Auditing
Few-Shot	Style matching	Low	Digital Twins
Role Prompting	Simulations	Low	VR/AR Design
Zero-Shot	Quick retrieval	Very Low	OS Integration
CRISPE	Long-term projects	High	App Building
PRIME	Strategic work	Very High	Master Framework

Master These Frameworks

Transform Your Coaching Practice with AI

The coaches who thrive in the AI era won't be those who resist technology-they'll be those who master it as a force multiplier for human insight and impact.

Leaderize:

Ignite Change, Realize Potential, Shape the Future.